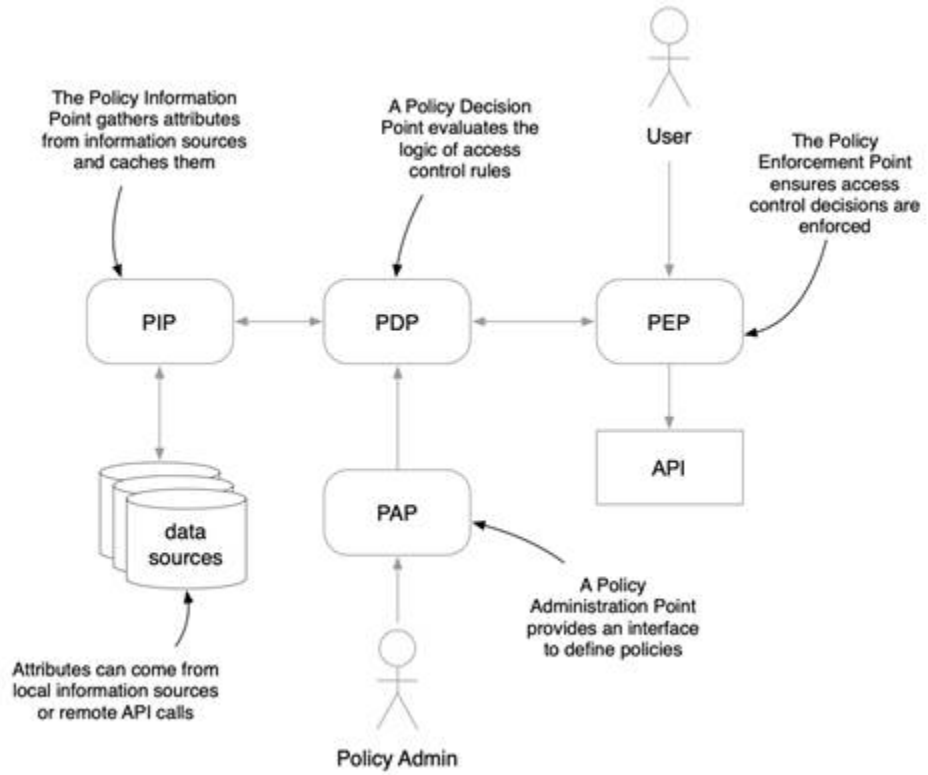


Figure 8.5 XACML defines four services that cooperate to implement an ABAC system. The Policy Enforcement Point (PEP) rejects requests that are denied by the Policy Decision Point (PDP). The Policy Information Point (PIP) retrieves attributes that are relevant to policy decisions. A Policy Administration Point (PAP) can be used to define and manage policies.

The four components may be collocated or can be distributed on different machines. In particular, the XACML architecture allows policy definitions to be centralized within an organization allowing easy administration and review. Multiple PEPs for different APIs can talk to the PDP via an API (typically a REST API), and XACML supports the concept of *policy sets* to allow policies for different PEPs to be grouped